TG ACADEMY / EXECUTIVE LEARNING

PRIORITY INTELLIGENCE

WEEK 2

THE VALUES-TO-ACTION ALIGNMENT CHAIN

Understand beliefs, behaviours and pressures before attempting to change routines.

Time awareness begins with an honest account of how you relate to time, not with a new productivity app.

BELIEFS | BEHAVIOURS | BOUNDARIES

TIME IS EXPERIENCED THROUGH

Beliefs → “I must always be available”

Choices → What receives attention

Constraints → Work, care, resources

Emotions → Stress, guilt, urgency

VALUES, GOALS AND MEANINGFUL PRIORITIES

Why priorities must begin with values

VALUES

What you consider important: family, integrity, learning, contribution, health.

GOALS

Specific outcomes that express your values over time.

PRIORITIES

The few commitments that deserve attention now.

TIME CHOICES

Calendar decisions reveal what is actually being protected.

Example: Valuing learning does not automatically protect study time; a weekly session converts the value into a choice.

Ask learners: Which stated value is least visible in your calendar?

THE VALUES-TO-ACTION ALIGNMENT CHAIN

1. NAME THE VALUE
Choose a personally meaningful principle, not a socially expected answer.

2. DEFINE THE OUTCOME
Describe what progress would look like in the next 30–90 days.



3. CHOOSE A PRIORITY
Select the highest-leverage activity supporting that outcome.

4. RESERVE REAL CAPACITY
Give it time that fits work, care, rest and other commitments.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION : Health → maintain wellbeing → consistent activity → two realistic 25-minute walks.

DISCUSS: What is the smallest credible action that reflects one important value?

CASE LAB: SUCCESS WITHOUT ALIGNMENT

TENSION: Income, progression and family commitments all matter; not all demands are optional.

OPTIONS: Negotiate shifts; defer a lower-value commitment; protect a study block; seek support.

DECISION: Choose a response based on consequences, values and realistic capacity.

DECISION LAB: Nadia is praised for taking extra shifts but repeatedly misses an essential qualification deadlin



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION: Discuss what cannot be changed, what can be negotiated, and how to avoid judging others' constraints.

TEACH & DISCUSS: Invite two different defensible choices and their trade-offs.

URGENCY, IMPORTANCE AND THE EISENHOWER DECISION MATRIX

Urgent is not the same as important

URGENT: Needs attention soon because of a deadline or immediate consequence.

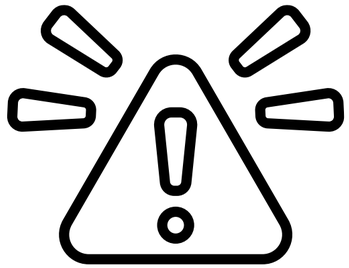
IMPORTANT: Contributes meaningfully to responsibilities, values or longer-term outcomes.

THE TRAP: Urgency can dominate because it is visible, noisy and externally imposed.

THE TEST: What happens if this is delayed and what meaningful outcome does it support?

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Example: an imminent safeguarding issue is both urgent and important; a routine notification may be neither.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask learners for a high-importance activity with no immediate deadline.



THE FOUR-QUADRANT PRIORITY MATRIX

Q1 URGENT + IMPORTANT
Act appropriately now: genuine crises and essential deadlines.

Q2 IMPORTANT + NOT URGENT
Schedule: learning, prevention, relationships and strategic work.



Q3 URGENT + LESS IMPORTANT
Clarify, shorten, redirect or delegate when appropriate.

Q4 NEITHER
Reduce, remove or intentionally limit.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Important: context matters; the same activity can fall into different quadrants for different people.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask: Which quadrant is crowded in your week, and why?

DECISION DRILL: SORT SIX DEMANDS



Tomorrow's essential client deadline.



A professional qualification with no immediate due date.



A non-essential meeting invitation with a same-day RSVP.



An unexpected dependent-care need.



Repeated checking of non-essential app alerts.



Preventive preparation for a project due next month.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Have participants assign each to a quadrant, state assumptions and defend one boundary decision.

TEACH & DISCUSS • **Debrief:** classify by actual consequences, not by the sender's urgency.

PRIORITISING ACROSS WORK, PERSONAL LIFE AND LONG-TERM GOALS

One life, multiple legitimate priorities

WORK / STUDY: Deadlines, learning, service delivery and professional obligations.

FAMILY / CARE: Dependants, relationships and shared responsibilities.bligations.

HEALTH / RECOVERY: Sleep, treatment, movement and restorative time.

FUTURE DEVELOPMENT: Qualifications, savings, skills and meaningful aspirations.



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Prioritisation is not simply choosing work over life, or life over work; it is a contextual balancing process.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask which category receives time only after everything else.

THE BALANCED-PRIORITY PORTFOLIO

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Essential care, safety, required duties and necessary recovery.

PROGRESS PRIORITIES

Two or three outcomes that materially advance your goals.

MAINTENANCE

Recurring administration and household functioning.

OPTIONAL

Activities that can be reduced, moved or declined.

Sample week: Essential school collection; finish a report; complete a learning module; maintain rest.

Teach and Discuss: Have learners identify one category that is being under-protected.

CASE LAB: THE COMPETING WEEK

SCENARIO: A postgraduate student works four days, supports a parent and has an assessment due.

CONSTRAINTS: Care appointments are fixed; study hours are flexible but energy is limited.

TRADE-OFFS: Protect short study blocks, request deadline clarification, share suitable errands.

GOOD DECISION: One that meets essential obligations and advances the assessment realistically.



EXAMPLE: Ask groups to design a weekly priority mix without filling every available hour.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Debrief: avoid 'perfect' schedules that depend on zero disruption.

MANAGING COMPETING PRIORITIES AND DIFFICULT TRADE-OFFS

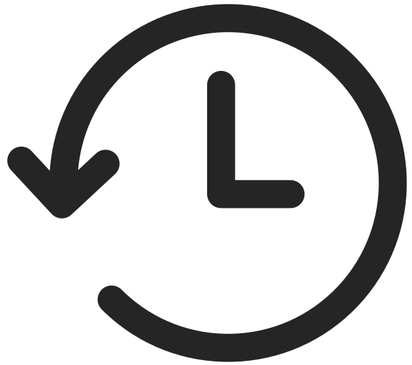
When everything seems important

CONSEQUENCE: What will happen if this waits?

DEPENDENCY: Who or what relies on this being completed first?

TIME SENSITIVITY: Is the deadline real, negotiable or assumed?

CAPACITY: Can this be done well without displacing essentials?



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • High-priority decisions should account for other people, legal duties and wellbeing.

TEACH & DISCUSS : What evidence would change your ranking?

A FIVE-QUESTION PRIORITY DECISION FILTER

1. PURPOSE
A postgraduate student works four days, supports a parent and has an assessment due.

2. IMPACT
What is the consequence of doing or delaying it?.

3. TIMING
When is action genuinely required?

4. RESOURCES
What time, energy or help does it require?

5. TRADE-OFF
What must be postponed or reduced if I say yes?

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Use the filter before accepting a new commitment, not after the calendar is full.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Invite a learner to apply it to a current request.

SCENARIO: THREE REQUESTS, ONE AFTERNOON

DECISION LAB

Resolve a safety-critical issue before the end of the day.

REQUEST B
Join an optional meeting with no agenda.

REQUEST C
Complete a milestone that unlocks colleagues' work tomorrow.

CHOICE
Protect A and C; clarify or decline B; communicate timing early.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Ask groups to propose a different choice if new information changes the consequences.

TEACH & DISCUSS • **Debrief:** prioritisation is a transparent decision, not a personality trait.

UNDERSTANDING THE COST OF SAYING YES AND PROTECTING BOUNDARIES

Every yes has an opportunity cost

DIRECT COST: Time and attention required by the new commitment.

DISPLACEMENT: What existing activity gets postponed or shortened.

HIDDEN COST: Preparation, switching, travel, recovery or follow-up.

RELATIONAL COST: Expectations created by repeated unqualified agreement.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Not every yes is optional; the skill is to recognise and communicate trade-offs.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask: Which recurring yes has an underestimated hidden cost?



BOUNDARIES THAT PRESERVE RELATIONSHIPS

CLARIFY
'Which of these deliverables is the priority?'

REDIRECT
'This belongs with the team that owns the decision.'



NEGOTIATE
'I can complete A today; B would need Thursday.'

DECLINE
'I cannot take on another optional commitment this week.'

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Good boundaries are specific, respectful and responsive to genuine emergencies.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Practise saying each phrase in a realistic tone.

Role-play: the extra COMMITMENT

1 SITUATION

A manager asks for an additional report when two deadlines are already agreed.

2 POOR RESPONSE

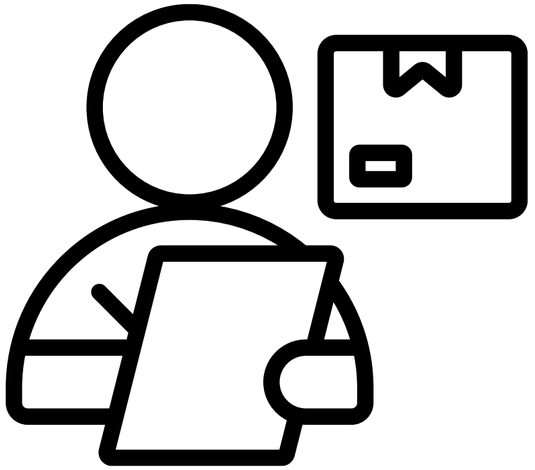
Say yes without clarifying scope, then work late and miss another obligation.

3 BETTER RESPONSE

Explain capacity; ask what should move; offer a realistic alternative.

4 LEARNING

Boundary-setting makes the cost of a decision visible.



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • **Pair exercise:** requester and responder; switch roles after two minutes.

TEACH & DISCUSS • **Debrief:** how did tone, evidence and options affect the conversation?

ELIMINATE, REDUCE, DELEGATE, DEFER OR DECLINE

FIVE PRACTICAL WAYS TO RECLAIM CAPACITY

ELIMINATE: Remove activities that no longer serve a purpose.

REDUCE: Shorten duration, frequency or unnecessary scope.

DELEGATE: Transfer appropriate work with clarity and support.

DEFER: Move genuinely non-urgent work to a deliberate later date.

DECLINE: Do not accept optional work that does not fit priorities.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Delegation requires authority and resources; it is not simply passing pressure to someone else.



TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask participants to name one candidate for each action.

The COMMITMENT REDESIGN BOARD

- **STOP:** Duplicate updates and obsolete reports.
- **SIMPLIFY:** Turn a 60-minute status meeting into a 20-minute decision meeting.
- **SHARE:** Assign defined preparation tasks to the right owners.
- **SCHEDULE:** Place non-urgent administration into a suitable block.



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Check dependencies, stakeholder expectations and quality requirements before changing work.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask: Which change offers the highest benefit with the lowest disruption?

Case study: an overloaded TEAM

SYMPTOM
A small team has five recurring meetings, overlapping reports and delayed client work.

DIAGNOSIS
Duplicated information and unclear decision ownership.

INTERVENTION
Eliminate one report; reduce two meetings; delegate data preparation.

MEASURE
Track decision speed, workload and service quality for two weeks.



EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Small-group task: redesign the workflow without removing essential governance.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Debrief: what safeguards make delegation and elimination responsible?

CREATING A PERSONAL PRIORITY HIERARCHY AND DECISION SCORECARD

BUILD A HIERARCHY BEFORE PRESSURE ARRIVES

LEVEL 1 ESSENTIAL
Safety, health, care and non-negotiable obligations.

LEVEL 2 CRITICAL OUTCOMES
High-impact commitments and consequential deadlines.



LEVEL 3 STRATEGIC PROGRESS
Learning, prevention, relationships and future goals.

LEVEL 4 OPTIONAL
Low-impact requests and discretionary activities.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • The hierarchy guides decisions but does not replace contextual judgement.

TEACH & DISCUSS • Ask: Which level is repeatedly displaced by lower-value activity?

A 25-POINT PRIORITY SCORECARD

IMPACT / 5A How meaningful is the expected outcome?

CONSEQUENCE / 5
What happens if this is delayed?

ALIGNMENT / 5
How strongly does it fit responsibilities or goals?

TIME SENSITIVITY / 5
How real and near is the deadline?

FEASIBILITY / 5
Can I act with available capacity and resources?







EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Total /25 supports comparison; it is a discussion aid, not an automatic decision rule.

TE**ACH & DISCUSS:** Use the same scoring definitions for competing activities.

YOUR WEEKLY PRIORITY DECISION WORKSHOP

DECISION LAB

List five competing activities for next week.

STEP 2
Score each using the five criteria; note essential obligations.

STEP 3
Select up to three meaningful weekly outcomes.

STEP 4
Schedule actions, protect flexibility and review the result.

EXAMPLE / APPLICATION • Exit ticket: 'I will protect ___; I will reduce ___; I will review on ___.'

TEACH & DISCUSS • Facilitator: remind learners that scores cannot override safety or essential care.



THANK YOU

Any Question?